

OPS · INTERNAL

Receipt OCR to Sheets to Tax

Forward any receipt to a Gmail alias. Claude reads the photo, extracts vendor + total + VAT + category, drops a clean row into your bookkeeping sheet.

THE PROBLEM

Shoebox of receipts. Crying accountant in March.

You buy a \$48 Notion seat on Tuesday, a \$312 client dinner on Friday, an Uber on Saturday. By the end of the quarter you have 180 receipts in 4 inboxes, 3 banking apps, and a glovebox. Your bookkeeper charges \$90/hr to type them in. You miss VAT reclaim because the photos are blurry and out of order. Stop hand-keying. Email the photo to one alias and let Claude do the OCR + categorisation in 6 seconds.

\$2.8K

BOOKKEEPER HAND-KEYING / YR

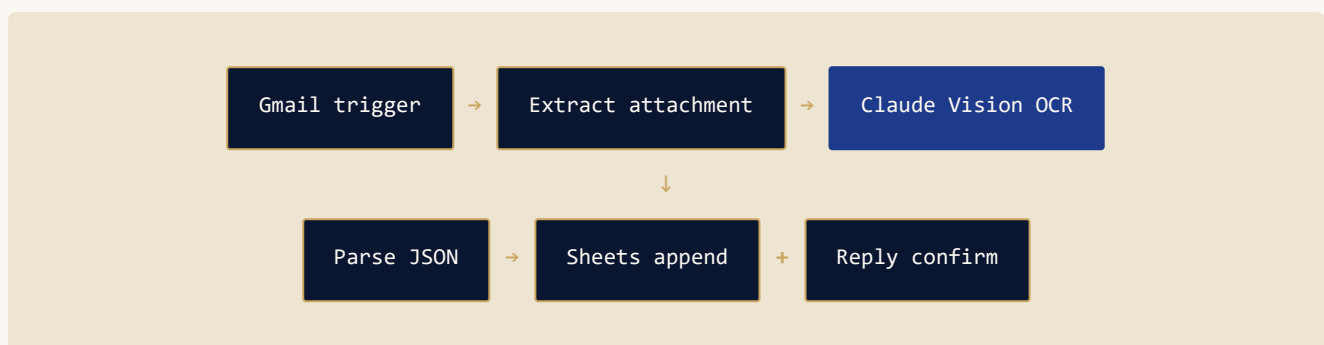
180+

RECEIPTS LOST PER QUARTER

Built for

- Solo founders + 2-10 person agencies on Xero / QuickBooks
- Consultants who reimburse via Wise / Revolut Business
- Anyone with > 30 expense receipts / month

The flow



BUILD IT

Stack & setup

Tech stack

LAYER	TOOL	COST/MO
Orchestration	n8n (self-host / cloud)	\$6-20
Inbound	Gmail alias (receipts+you@gmail.com)	\$0
Vision OCR	Claude Sonnet 4.6 (vision)	\$3-8
Storage	Google Sheets + Drive folder	\$0
Total	—	\$9-28

Before you import

- n8n instance (self-host DO \$6/mo OR n8n.cloud trial)
- Gmail account with sub-address alias enabled (receipts+ocr@gmail.com)
- Anthropic API key with \$10+ credit (vision pricing applies)
- Google Drive folder named `receipts-archive`
- Google Sheet with tabs: `ledger` (date, vendor, total, currency, vat, category, payment_method, raw_url, notes) and `errors`

Setup (30-60 min fresh, 15 min if n8n already wired)

1. Spin up n8n: `docker run -d -p 5678:5678 n8nio/n8n` or n8n.cloud
2. Gmail → Settings → Forwarding → enable + create alias receipts+ocr@
3. n8n credentials: add Gmail OAuth2, Anthropic API, Google Sheets OAuth, Google Drive OAuth
4. Workflows → Import from Clipboard → paste JSON from page 4
5. Bind every REPLACE_ME credential to the ones you just created
6. Replace REPLACE_ME_SHEET_ID and REPLACE_ME_DRIVE_FOLDER with your IDs
7. Forward one real receipt to the alias, run workflow once, verify row in Sheet, then activate

Skill level: Beginner. No code. Tweak the Claude prompt if your local VAT rules differ.

COPY + PASTE

n8n workflow JSON



Copy from GitHub →

One click. Opens raw file with native copy button.



SCAN ON
MOBILE

Or import the file 11-receipt-ocr-sheets-tax.json from the pack folder. In n8n: **Workflows** → **Import from Clipboard / File**.

```
{
  "name": "11 - Receipt OCR to Sheets to Tax",
  "nodes": [
    {
      "parameters": {
        "pollTimes": {
          "item": [
            {
              "mode": "everyMinute"
            }
          ]
        },
        "simple": false,
        "filters": {
          "q": "to:(receipts+ocr@gmail.com) has:attachment newer_than:1d"
        },
        "options": {
          "downloadAttachments": true
        }
      },
      "id": "trigger-gmail",
      "name": "Gmail receipts inbox",
      "type": "n8n-nodes-base.gmailTrigger",
      "typeVersion": 1.2,
      "position": [200, 300],
      "credentials": {
        "gmailOAuth2": {
          "id": "REPLACE_ME_GMAIL",
          "name": "Gmail OAuth2"
        }
      }
    },
    {
      "parameters": {
        "jsCode": "const out = [];\nfor (const item of $input.all()) {\n  const atts = item.binary || {};\n  for\n  (const key of Object.keys(atts)) {\n    const att = atts[key];\n    if (!att.mimeType ||\n    !/image|pdf/i.test(att.mimeType)) continue;\n    out.push({\n      message_id: item.json.id,\n      from: item.json.from?.value?.[0]?.address || item.json.from,\n      subject: item.json.subject,\n      received_at: item.json.date,\n      attachment_name: att.fileName,\n      mime_type: att.mimeType\n    });\n    binary: { data: att }\n  });\n}\nreturn out;"
      },
      "id": "extract-attachments",
      "name": "Extract image attachments",
      "type": "n8n-nodes-base.code",
      "typeVersion": 2,
      "position": [420, 300]
    },
    {
      "parameters": {
        "name": "={{ $now.format('yyyy-MM-dd-HH:mm:ss') }}-{{ $json.attachment_name }}"
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

WANT THIS BUILT FOR YOU?

Three ways forward

Most teams can wire this in an afternoon. Some can't — or shouldn't waste their best hour on it. If that's you:

Done-for-you build

I install + customize this exact flow on your n8n. 7-day delivery. 30-day fix-it warranty.

\$297-997

FIVERR

Free 20-min audit

I review your stack + name the 3 highest-leverage automations for your business. No pitch.

Free

EMAIL

Monthly retainer

Fractional ops engineer for your stack. Slack-first, 48h SLA. Agencies + 8-fig brands.

\$1.5K-5K

EMAIL

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